

JOSHUA HICKMAN

Linux Systems Administration · Networking · IT Operations

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SUMMARY

U.S. Army veteran moving into Linux systems administration, networking, and IT operations after two decades of designing, documenting, and keeping various multi-component non-computing systems running. I run a premises lab (routers, segmented networks, Ubuntu and Rocky servers, Linux and Windows desktops) and am preparing for the LFCS exam (targeted September 2026). I use AI tools such as Grok Build and Claude Code to research, draft, and configure while I learn; I type the commands, test the result, and own what I ship. I am seeking technician and/or administrator work with MSPs and internal IT teams to help me progress in my career change journey.

SKILLS

- Linux administration: Ubuntu and Rocky Linux servers and desktops, CLI daily (files, packages, systemctl basics), rebuild and configuration procedures
- Networking and access: design and deploy routers, segmented networks (lab / home / guest / IoT), Starlink and mesh Wi-Fi, Tailscale, remote SSH; troubleshoot from official docs plus AI tools
- Infrastructure operations: image and deploy workstations (Linux and Windows), VirtualBox and Multipass, firewall defaults (deny-by-default; UFW and firewalld basics), service documentation
- Troubleshooting and design: signal-flow / process-flow diagnosis, phased implementation, root-cause work under time pressure
- Reliability and documentation: SOPs, runbooks, inventories, audit-ready records, Lean Six Sigma Yellow Belt (DMAIC)
- People and delivery: training non-technical operators, stakeholder communication, ticket ownership, handoff so systems run without one person
- Scripting and data: Bash, Python fundamentals, Git basics (AI tools assist with more complex Git); SQL / PostgreSQL fundamentals
- AI-assisted operations: Grok Build, Claude Code, Ollama, Gemini CLI, GitHub Copilot — used to set up and configure systems while I learn; I still run, test, and document the result

INFRASTRUCTURE IN PRACTICE

Premises lab — routers, servers, desktops, and segmented networks

Independent lab in daily use · 2025 – Present · VyOS, Ubuntu/Rocky, Tailscale, Multipass/VirtualBox · github.com/DestroyTheKraken

- Designed and operate a segmented home/lab network: Starlink, a VyOS edge I configured by hand (with AI research and debug help), Ubuntu lab hosts, and Linux/Windows desktops.
- Practice default-deny firewalls (UFW/firewalld basics), Tailscale for remote access, VirtualBox and Multipass for disposable labs, and written notes for rebuilds.
- Public repos document the lab and small installers (SSH/UFW/Tailscale bootstrap, Nextcloud installer). AI tools help me write and configure; I review and run everything myself.

Takeaway: this is daily infrastructure work — design, implementation, documentation, and reliability — practiced on real hardware, not coursework sitting unused.

EXPERIENCE

Linux Systems, Networking, and IT Operations — Career Transition

Independent professional development · Omak, WA · July 2025 – Present

- Completed Linux Foundation LFS101 (Apr 2026) and LFS207 (Apr 2026); badges on Credly. LFCS exam purchased; target September 2026 (voucher through March 2027).
- Completed Google AI Essentials specialization on Coursera (Sep 2025, five courses) and Nucamp Python Fundamentals and Web Development Fundamentals.
- Deploy and maintain Linux servers (Ubuntu, Rocky), desktops, and the lab router; live in the CLI for files, systemctl, and host configuration. AI tools help me set things up as I learn; I test and own the result.

Takeaway: current work already maps to technician and junior-administrator duties — services, access, documentation, and repeatable operations — while formal credentials finish on a dated path.

County Compliance Planner

Okanogan County Office of Planning & Development · March 2024 – July 2025

- Processed permits and applications against county and state requirements.
- Maintained official records and wrote departmental standard operating procedures.

Takeaway: this developed disciplined record-keeping and process documentation that maps to change control, ticket notes, and audit-ready IT operations.

Senior Pastor and Organizational Leader

New Life Center / New Life Church, Okanogan, WA · December 2022 – January 2025

- Ran day-to-day operations for a small nonprofit: scheduling, facilities, communications, volunteers, and public-facing work.
- Used DMAIC process improvement to rebuild policies, budgets, reporting, and leadership training; membership moved from 18 to 55 and finances from an annual loss to a surplus.
- Administered collaboration platforms (Google Workspace, Planning Center, Breeze) and trained staff and volunteers on those systems.

Takeaway: this refined multi-hat operations, systems implementation, and end-user training — the same pattern as a small IT shop or MSP bench with limited headcount.

Training Systems and S6 Support

U.S. Army, 1st Medical Brigade, Fort Hood, TX · 2013 – 2016

- Administered enterprise training information systems (DTMS / ATRRS) for 3,500+ soldiers and kept records audit-ready.
- Supported S6 with PC deployment, VOIP, AV systems, and SharePoint; completed Army IT training covering VMs, hardware, and collaboration platforms.
- Wrote and validated SOPs for severe-weather and CBRNE response; supported large-scale exercises involving 4,000+ personnel.
- Awards: Army Commendation Medal, Army Good Conduct Medal, two Special Achievement Medals.

Takeaway: closest prior match to enterprise IT operations — information systems, endpoint and comms support, SOP design, and reliability under operational pressure.

Audio Systems Engineer and Consultant

Self-employed · 2005 – 2025

- Designed, installed, and optimized multi-component sound-reinforcement systems; diagnosed signal-chain failures during live events.
- Operated a mobile recording studio end-to-end and trained volunteer operators to run systems after handoff.

Takeaway: this built systems design, live troubleshooting, and operator training — infrastructure work expressed as signal flow rather than packets.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

- LFCS — exam purchased; target sitting September 2026 (voucher through March 2027). Additional path: CompTIA Linux+ and Network+ within 12 months.
- Linux Foundation LFS101: Introduction to Linux (Credly, Apr 3, 2026) · LFS207: Linux System Administration Essentials (Credly, Apr 15, 2026).
- Google AI Essentials specialization, Coursera / Google (Sep 12, 2025) — five courses.
- Nucamp — Python Fundamentals; Web Development Fundamentals.
- Lean Six Sigma Yellow Belt (Alison).
- Master of Theology, Crown Institute of Theology (WA state-licensed), 2020–2026.
- U.S. Army Medical Training Center — Patient Administration certificate; Army IT / VM / SharePoint training.

References available upon request. · credly.com/users/joshua-hickman.cfd7e15